

BANARAS HINDU UNIVERSITY

B.A. / B.Sc. / B.Com. (Hons.) — Semester III Examination, 2025-26 (NEP)

Ability Enhancement Course (AEC)**Paper Code: ENGAE-31 : Reading Skills**

Time: 1.5 Hours

Maximum Marks: 70

*Instructions: Answer all questions. Each question carries equal marks (1 mark each).***Question 1.** The best correction of the sentence, “Their going to the market,” would be: [1]

- (A) There going to the market
- (B) Their gone to the market
- (C) They’re going to the market
- (D) Its going to the market

Question 2. The line “The road was a ribbon of moonlight” (from the poem *The Highwayman* by Alfred Noyes) is an example of: [1]

- (A) Literal meaning
- (B) Metaphoric comparison
- (C) Factual reporting
- (D) Note-taking and summary

Question 3. Writing the words “cat,” “dog,” and “run” as /kæt/, /d/, and /rn/ is an example of: [1]

- (A) Phonic pronunciation
- (B) Intensive reading
- (C) Skimming a text
- (D) Silent reading

Question 4. Which of these is NOT an external barrier to a student’s reading comprehension? [1]

- (A) Noisy classroom environment
- (B) Lack of encouragement by teacher
- (C) Jokes about pronunciation by other students
- (D) Severe headache and fever

Question 5. Sunil doesn't know the meaning of the word "dubious," but is able to guess it from the sentence, "I could never trust him and found all his excuses to be dubious." What is this an example of? [1]

- (A) Predictive reading / Contextual guessing
- (B) Error detection and editing
- (C) Extensive reading
- (D) Graphic organization

Question 6. Skimming a text is primarily used for: [1]

- (A) Finding the main idea or gist quickly
- (B) Memorizing line by line
- (C) Checking punctuation errors
- (D) Translating word for word

Question 7. Scanning a reading passage involves: [1]

- (A) Searching for a specific piece of information or fact
- (B) Reading every sentence in detail
- (C) Summarizing the whole chapter
- (D) Pronouncing words aloud

Question 8. Intensive reading focuses on: [1]

- (A) Detailed comprehension and careful analysis of text
- (B) Fast casual reading for fun
- (C) Skipping difficult words
- (D) Looking at pictures only

Question 9. Extensive reading encourages students to: [1]

- (A) Read large volumes of text for general understanding and pleasure
- (B) Analyze every grammatical rule
- (C) Memorize the entire book
- (D) Avoid reading long stories

Question 10. Inferential reading requires a reader to: [1]

- (A) Read between the lines to uncover hidden meanings
- (B) Copy sentences verbatim

- (C) Read only the titles
- (D) Count the number of paragraphs

Question 11. Critical reading involves: [1]

- (A) Evaluating the author's arguments, logic, and evidence
- (B) Accepting all statements without questioning
- (C) Reading as fast as possible
- (D) Ignoring the author's perspective

Question 12. Active reading strategies include: [1]

- (A) Annotating, highlighting, and asking questions while reading
- (B) Passively skimming without taking notes
- (C) Staring at text without focus
- (D) Reading while watching television

Question 13. A reader uses background knowledge (schema) to: [1]

- (A) Connect prior experience with new text information
- (B) Forget previous lessons
- (C) Ignore the author's topic
- (D) Replace reading with guessing

Question 14. Identifying the central thesis of an essay helps to understand: [1]

- (A) The main point or main argument of the author
- (B) The font size used by the publisher
- (C) The cost of the book
- (D) The biographical background of the reader

Question 15. In reading, context clues help a student to: [1]

- (A) Determine the meaning of unfamiliar words from surrounding text
- (B) Skip the page entirely
- (C) Memorize dictionary definitions
- (D) Avoid reading long paragraphs

Question 16. A summary of a reading passage should be: [1]

- (A) Brief, objective, and focused on key points

- (B) Longer than the original text
- (C) Full of personal opinions and slang
- (D) An exact word-for-word copy

Question 17. Paraphrasing means: [1]

- (A) Restating an author's ideas in your own words
- (B) Quoting directly with quotation marks
- (C) Changing only one word in a sentence
- (D) Deleting paragraphs

Question 18. Figurative language in literature includes: [1]

- (A) Similes, metaphors, and personification
- (B) Literal dictionary definitions only
- (C) Numerical statistics
- (D) Bibliographical footnotes

Question 19. Reading comprehension is best defined as: [1]

- (A) Understanding, interpreting, and making sense of written text
- (B) Pronouncing words correctly without knowing their meaning
- (C) Memorizing sentence structures
- (D) Speed reading without retention

Question 20. SQ3R study method stands for: [1]

- (A) Survey, Question, Read, Recite, Review
- (B) Speak, Quote, Read, Write, Repeat
- (C) Scan, Quick, Read, Rewrite, Record
- (D) Search, Question, Reasoning, Review, Report

Question 21. An author's purpose in writing a text can be to: [1]

- (A) Inform, persuade, or entertain
- (B) Confuse the audience deliberately
- (C) Waste paper
- (D) Print random symbols

Question 22. The tone of a text reflects: [1]

- (A) The author's attitude toward the subject or audience
- (B) The size of the paper
- (C) The length of the chapter
- (D) The time of day it was read

Question 23. Which reading speed is best suited for reviewing textbook material before an exam? [1]

- (A) Flexible reading speed adjusted to difficulty
- (B) Ultra-fast skimming without stopping
- (C) Slow word-by-word decoding
- (D) Reading backwards

Question 24. Graphic organizers like Mind Maps help readers to: [1]

- (A) Visualize relationships between ideas
- (B) Avoid taking written notes
- (C) Replace reading comprehension
- (D) Color pages for decoration

Question 25. Fact vs. Opinion: Which statement is a FACT? [1]

- (A) The sun rises in the east
- (B) English is the most beautiful language
- (C) Reading is more fun than sports
- (D) Summer is better than winter

Question 26. Fact vs. Opinion: Which statement is an OPINION? [1]

- (A) Water freezes at 0 degrees Celsius
- (B) This novel is the most exciting book ever written
- (C) Banaras Hindu University was founded in 1916
- (D) Oxygen is required for human respiration

Question 27. Making predictions while reading involves: [1]

- (A) Anticipating what will happen next based on text clues
- (B) Guessing the price of the book
- (C) Writing the ending before starting
- (D) Reading only the back cover

Question 28. Vocabulary in context can be understood using: [1]

- (A) Synonyms, antonyms, and explanation clues in the sentence
- (B) Random guessing
- (C) Skipping all difficult words
- (D) Counting letters in a word

Question 29. Which technique improves reading fluency? [1]

- (A) Reading in meaningful word chunks rather than word-by-word
- (B) Finger pointing to every single letter
- (C) Stopping after every word
- (D) Reading aloud at maximum speed

Question 30. Subvocalization refers to: [1]

- (A) Silent internal speech while reading text
- (B) Shouting words in class
- (C) Listening to an audiobook
- (D) Writing notes on paper

Question 31. A main idea is different from a supporting detail because: [1]

- (A) The main idea gives the overarching point, while details provide evidence
- (B) Details are always placed in title headers
- (C) Main ideas only appear in footnotes
- (D) They are identical in function

Question 32. When evaluating an online source for research reading, check for: [1]

- (A) Authority, accuracy, objectivity, and currency
- (B) Bright colors and background music
- (C) Number of pop-up advertisements
- (D) Social media shares only

Question 33. Common spelling errors due to homophones include confusing: [1]

- (A) "Their", "There", and "They're"
- (B) "Cat" and "Dog"
- (C) "Book" and "Pen"

(D) “Run” and “Walk”

Question 34. Phonetic confusion in reading often happens when words: [1]

- (A) Sound similar but have different spellings and meanings
- (B) Are written in uppercase letters
- (C) Have short definitions
- (D) Are printed in bold font

Question 35. Confusing words like “receive” and “relieve” involves: [1]

- (A) Spelling rule exceptions (e.g. *i before e except after c*)
- (B) Math calculation errors
- (C) Punctuation mistakes
- (D) Translation errors

Question 36. Engaged readers are typically: [1]

- (A) Interested, motivated, and persistent despite text challenges
- (B) Passive and easily bored
- (C) Unwilling to seek clarification
- (D) Focused only on exam grades

Question 37. Which of the following is NOT a true characteristic of reading? [1]

- (A) It does not improve overall communication skills
- (B) It is an active cognitive process
- (C) It can be both individual and collaborative
- (D) It involves mental processing and comprehension

Question 38. In group discussions about reading, students should focus on: [1]

- (A) Sharing ideas and experiences constructively
- (B) Debating to win arguments
- (C) Trying to read faster than others
- (D) Criticizing classmates’ opinions

Question 39. A supportive classroom environment for reading development includes: [1]

- (A) Social, personal, and cognitive dimensions
- (B) Strict silence and no discussion

- (C) Rote memorization drills
- (D) Speed tests only

Question 40. Which of the following is NOT a core language domain? [1]

- (A) Scrolling social media reels
- (B) Writing
- (C) Listening and Speaking
- (D) Reading

Question 41. What is Reading Stamina? [1]

- (A) The ability to read long texts for extended periods of time with focus
- (B) The speed at which you flip pages
- (C) The volume at which you read aloud
- (D) The ability to make dramatic expressions while reading

Question 42. What does the step “Breaking it Down” signify in the reading process? [1]

- (A) Breaking a long, complex text into smaller, manageable pieces
- (B) Reading aloud at high volume
- (C) Breaking a promise to a friend
- (D) Tearing pages out of a book

Question 43. How does graphic organization help readers? [1]

- (A) It helps keep track of concepts and relationships visually
- (B) It decorates notes with random pictures
- (C) It prevents students from reading books
- (D) It tests spelling speed

Question 44. Setting reading goals is important for: [1]

- (A) Varying reading strategies according to specific purpose
- (B) Memorizing entire texts word for word
- (C) Avoiding texts altogether
- (D) Reading in an unsystematic manner

Question 45. Financial “bank” and river “bank” are examples of homonyms. Homonyms are defined as: [1]

- (A) Two words with the same spelling and pronunciation but different meanings

- (B) Words with opposite meanings
- (C) Words that rhyme at the end
- (D) Words with different spellings and opposite meanings

Question 46. What is the correct definition of Homophones? [1]

- (A) Two words with the same pronunciation but different spellings and meanings
- (B) Two words with the exact same meaning and spelling
- (C) Two words with opposite meanings
- (D) Two words with different spellings and identical meanings

Question 47. “Hot” and “cold” are antonyms. Antonyms are defined as: [1]

- (A) Two different words with directly opposing meanings
- (B) Words with identical meanings
- (C) Words that sound the same
- (D) Words spelled identically

Question 48. Which of the following is a pair of rhyming words? [1]

- (A) light, night
- (B) off, rough
- (C) tough, though
- (D) move, love

Question 49. Which of the following is NOT a pair of rhyming words? [1]

- (A) shove, groove
- (B) cat, hat
- (C) sing, ring
- (D) book, look

Question 50. In the sentence “She can sings very well,” the grammatical error is in: [1]

- (A) Verb form (“sings”)
- (B) Subject (“She”)
- (C) Word order
- (D) Article

Question 51. The sentence “They goes to school every day” contains an error in: [1]

- (A) Subject-verb agreement (“goes”)
- (B) Word choice (“school”)
- (C) Punctuation
- (D) Preposition (“to”)

Question 52. Which activity is used by teachers to prepare students before reading new text? [1]

- (A) Brainstorming: discussing prior knowledge about the topic
- (B) Height-order seating arrangement
- (C) Roll call sorting
- (D) Silent exam grading

Question 53. What is Visualization during reading? [1]

- (A) Being able to mentally picture scenes and information described in text
- (B) Reading printed paper instead of a screen
- (C) Staring at words without thinking
- (D) Reading aloud off a blackboard

Question 54. Which of the following is a positive peer interaction practice in reading class? [1]

- (A) Learning from each other’s diverse backgrounds and perspectives
- (B) Working on personal tasks while peers present
- (C) Isolating students by region
- (D) Avoiding group discussions

Question 55. Fluency in English is valuable in India and globally because: [1]

- (A) It acts as a connecting bridge language for education and careers
- (B) English is inherently superior to other languages
- (C) Exams are impossible without it
- (D) It prevents peer criticism

Question 56. Which of the following is NOT a valid set of terms related to the reading process? [1]

- (A) singing, competition, drama
- (B) text, engagement, competence
- (C) cognition, reading strategy, purpose

(D) fluency, chunking, paraphrasing

Question 57. Which of the following factors affects Readability of a text? [1]

(A) All of the above (Vocabulary difficulty, sentence length, and concept density)

(B) Sentence length and vocabulary difficulty

(C) Idea density and conceptual difficulty

(D) Topic relevance to the reader

Question 58. What is a key benefit of using the “Think-Aloud” strategy during reading? [1]

(A) It verbalizes the reader’s thought process (questions and predictions)

(B) It forces students to read faster

(C) It keeps the room quiet

(D) It replaces written tests

Reading Excerpt for Questions 59 to 61:

“The city was bustling with activity. People rushed to and fro, going about their daily business. The sounds of car horns, chatter, and construction filled the air.”

Question 59. What is the atmosphere of the city in the passage? [1]

(A) Bustling

(B) Peaceful

(C) Quiet

(D) Empty

Question 60. What type of sounds are mentioned in the passage? [1]

(A) A mix of urban sounds (horns, chatter, construction)

(B) Only natural sounds

(C) Silence

(D) Only animal sounds

Question 61. What are people doing in the city? [1]

(A) Going about their daily business

(B) Relaxing and resting

(C) Sleeping soundly

(D) Protesting

Reading Excerpt for Questions 62 to 64:

*“The sun was setting over the ocean, painting the sky with hues of pink and orange.
The waves gently lapped at the shore, creating a soothing melody.”*

Question 62. What is the tone of the passage? [1]

- (A) Calm and serene
- (B) Sad and depressing
- (C) Angry
- (D) Humorous

Question 63. What is happening to the sky in the passage? [1]

- (A) It is becoming colorful (pink and orange)
- (B) It is getting darker
- (C) It is getting lighter
- (D) It is disappearing

Question 64. What sound is created by the waves? [1]

- (A) A soothing melody
- (B) A loud noise
- (C) Complete silence
- (D) A chaotic sound

Reading Excerpt for Questions 65 to 67:

“The library was a quiet haven for students. Rows of books lined the shelves, and the musty smell of old books filled the air.”

Question 65. What is the atmosphere of the library? [1]

- (A) Quiet
- (B) Noisy
- (C) Crowded
- (D) Empty

Question 66. What fills the air in the library? [1]

- (A) The smell of old books
- (B) The smell of food
- (C) The sound of music

(D) The sound of chatter

Question 67. For whom is the library a haven?

[1]

(A) Students

(B) Teachers

(C) Tourists

(D) Researchers

Reading Excerpt for Questions 68 to 70:

“The old woman sat on the bench, watching the world go by. She smiled as children played in the park, their laughter echoing through the air.”

Question 68. What is the old woman doing?

[1]

(A) Watching the world go by

(B) Playing with children

(C) Watching TV

(D) Sleeping

Question 69. What was her reaction to the children?

[1]

(A) Smiling

(B) Frowning

(C) Scowling

(D) Shuddering

Question 70. What is echoing through the air?

[1]

(A) Children’s laughter

(B) The sound of traffic

(C) The sound of construction

(D) Music